

BRIDE BESTIE

The 12-Month Wedding Planning *Checklist*

Your month-by-month guide to planning the whole day —
without losing your mind.

Hey, bride-to-be 🙌

First — congratulations! You're engaged, and somewhere between the happy tears and the "wait, where do I even start?" panic, you found this. Take a breath. You've got a whole year (or however long you've got), and you do not have to figure it all out today.

I built this checklist to break the entire wedding down into small, doable steps, spread across the months ahead — so instead of one terrifying to-do list, you just handle a little at a time. Work top to bottom, tick things off as you go, and let the rest wait its turn.

How to use this checklist

- ✦ The timeframes are **guidelines, not rules** — planning in 6 months? Just start at the top and move faster.
- ✦ Tick the box once something's **booked or done**, not just researched.
- ✦ Print it and stick it on the fridge, or keep the PDF on your phone — whatever keeps you looking at it.
- ✦ Money and guest count come first on purpose: **almost every other decision depends on them.**
- ✦ Each page has a "**notes & my own to-dos**" block — jot down the bits that are unique to your day.
- ✦ Don't panic if a box stays empty for a while. **You're allowed to do this at your own pace.**

One last thing before you dive in: this is *your* wedding, not a competition or a checklist for anyone else. Skip what doesn't fit, add what does, and lean on the people who offered to help — most of them genuinely meant it. The goal isn't a flawless event; it's marrying your person surrounded by the people you love.

You've got this — I'm right here with you. xo, your Bride Bestie

The first few months

12+ months out JUST ENGAGED

- ☐ Celebrate & share the news with your people
- ☐ Decide on a rough date or season
- ☐ Choose your wedding party
- ☐ Settle on a vibe: formal, rustic, modern...
- ☐ Set your overall budget & who's contributing
- ☐ Draft an early guest-count range
- ☐ Start an inspiration board (hi, Pinterest)
- ☐ Tour venues & book the one — lock the date

10–12 months LOCK THE BIG VENDORS

- ☐ Hire a planner or day-of coordinator
- ☐ Book your videographer
- ☐ Start the dress search; book appointments
- ☐ Reserve a hotel room block for guests
- ☐ Open a dedicated wedding email & folder
- ☐ Book your photographer
- ☐ Book your caterer (if separate from venue)
- ☐ Build your full guest list with addresses
- ☐ Create your wedding website
- ☐ Start a simple budget spreadsheet

Notes & my own to-dos THESE MONTHS

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Getting into the details

8–10 months STYLE & SAVE-THE-DATES

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|---|---|
| ☐ Order your dress (alterations take time) | ☐ Book your florist |
| ☐ Book your band or DJ | ☐ Book your officiant |
| ☐ Choose & order save-the-dates | ☐ Send your save-the-dates |
| ☐ Decide on bridesmaid dresses | ☐ Sketch your ceremony details |

6–8 months FOOD, LOOKS & LOGISTICS

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|--|--|
| ☐ Book your cake baker; schedule tastings | ☐ Arrange transportation (shuttle, car) |
| ☐ Set up your gift registry | ☐ Book the honeymoon; check passports |
| ☐ Reserve rentals (linens, chairs, decor) | ☐ Shop groom & groomsmen attire |
| ☐ Book hair & makeup; schedule a trial | ☐ Plan the rehearsal dinner |
| ☐ Reserve guest transportation & parking | ☐ Choose ceremony & reception music style |

Notes & my own to-dos THESE MONTHS

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|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
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| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |

Pulling it together

4-6 months PAPER & PROMISES

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|---|---|
| ☐ Finalize the menu & do a tasting | ☐ Order invitations & stationery |
| ☐ Choose your wedding rings | ☐ Plan ceremony readings & vows |
| ☐ Confirm honeymoon bookings | ☐ Plan the bachelorette / bachelor party |
| ☐ Book any extras (photo booth, late-night snacks) | ☐ Start a day-of timeline draft |

2-4 months SEND & CONFIRM

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|--|--|
| ☐ Mail your invitations (about 8 weeks out) | ☐ Finalize the playlist & do-not-play list |
| ☐ First dress fitting | ☐ Purchase wedding favors |
| ☐ Write your vows | ☐ Buy gifts for the wedding party & parents |
| ☐ Apply for your marriage license | ☐ Confirm details with every vendor |
| ☐ Order signage, place cards & menus | ☐ Schedule a hair & makeup trial run |

Notes & my own to-dos THESE MONTHS

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|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |

The final stretch

6–8 weeks NUMBERS & SEATING

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|--|---|
| ☐ Track RSVPs; chase the stragglers | ☐ Give final guest count to caterer/venue |
| ☐ Build your seating chart | ☐ Final dress fitting |
| ☐ Break in your wedding shoes | ☐ Confirm the timeline with photographer & planner |
| ☐ Pick up your marriage license | ☐ Write thank-you notes as gifts arrive |

1–2 weeks HAND IT OFF

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|--|---|
| ☐ Confirm arrival times with all vendors | ☐ Delegate day-of tasks to your crew |
| ☐ Prepare final payments & tip envelopes | ☐ Assemble a day-of emergency kit |
| ☐ Pack for the honeymoon | ☐ Confirm transport & hotel details |
| ☐ Rehearse your vows out loud | ☐ Plan something relaxing for yourself |
| ☐ Print final timelines for the whole party | ☐ Charge cameras, phones & speakers |

Notes & my own to-dos THE FINAL STRETCH

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|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
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| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |

THE TIMELINE

The big day

Day before SET THE STAGE

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|---|--|
| ☐ Attend the rehearsal & rehearsal dinner | ☐ Drop off decor & items at the venue |
| ☐ Hand rings, vows & payments to your point person | ☐ Lay out everything you'll need tomorrow |
| ☐ Eat well & hydrate | ☐ Get a real night's sleep |
| ☐ Set out your "something old/new/borrowed/blue" | ☐ Charge your phone & silence notifications |

Wedding day SOAK IT IN

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|---|---|
| ☐ Eat a proper breakfast | ☐ Hair & makeup with your people around you |
| ☐ Take a quiet minute before it all begins | ☐ Trust your team — you've planned for this |
| ☐ Marry your favorite person 💍 | ☐ Dance, eat your cake, and be present |
| ☐ Hand off rings & vows to your point person | ☐ Sneak away together for five quiet minutes |

Notes & little reminders DON'T FORGET

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| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |

Want every detail in one place?

This checklist keeps you on schedule — but the day itself has a thousand moving pieces.

The Ultimate Wedding Planner turns this whole list into a full workbook, so your budget, guests, vendors, and timeline all live in one beautiful, organized place.

- ♥ The full 12-month checklist, expanded
- ♥ Guest list & RSVP manager
- ♥ Hour-by-hour day-of timeline
- ♥ Ceremony & reception detail planners
- ♥ Budget tracker that adds up for you
- ♥ Vendor contacts & payment tracker
- ♥ Seating chart & menu planner
- ♥ Honeymoon & packing checklists

[Get the full planner →](#)

Instant download · print at home or use on any device · everything you ticked here, expanded.

Happy planning, bestie.

bridebestie.com · @bridebestie

I hope this checklist takes a little weight off your shoulders. Whatever you decide about the full planner — I'm cheering you on. Come say hi anytime [@bridebestie](#).